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全国甲卷

阅读 D

如何为作品写好结局

说明文 · 文学与写作 · 全文 345 词 · 逐句精读

¹ “I didn’t like the ending,” I said to my favorite college professor.

“我不喜欢那个结局，” 我对大学里最喜欢的那位教授说。

ending n. 结局；结尾

college n. 大学；学院

professor n. 教授

² It was my **junior year** of college, and I was doing an **independent study** on **Victorian literature**.

那是我大学三年级的时候，我正在做一项关于维多利亚时代文学的独立研究。

junior year (大学) 三年级

independent adj. 独立的；自主的

study n. 研究

Victorian adj. 维多利亚时代的

literature n. 文学

³ I had just **finished reading** The **Mill** on the Floss by George Eliot, and I was **heartbroken** by the ending.

我刚读完乔治·艾略特的《弗洛斯河上的磨坊》，那个结局让我心碎。

finish doing 做完……

mill n. 磨坊

heartbroken adj. 心碎的；极度伤心的

⁴ Prof. Gracie, with all his **patience**, **asked me to think about it beyond whether** I liked it **or not**.

格雷西教授极有耐心地让我跳出“喜欢不喜欢”的层面，去思考这个结局。

patience n. 耐心

ask sb. to do 要求某人做……

think about 思考；考虑

beyond prep. 超出（……的范围）

whether...or not 是否……

5 He **suggested** I think about the **difference between** endings that I wanted for the **characters** **and** endings that were right for the characters, endings that **satisfied** the story **even if** they didn't have a **traditionally positive outcome**.

他建议我思考两种结局之间的区别：一种是我希望人物得到的结局，另一种是对人物而言恰当的结局，也就是能满足故事需要的结局，哪怕这样的结局在传统意义上并不算好结果。

suggest v. 建议

difference between...and与……之间的区别

character n. (小说等中的) 人物

satisfy v. 满足 (要求); 使满意

even if 即使

traditionally adv. 传统上

positive adj. 好的; 积极的

outcome n. 结果

⁶ Of course, I would have preferred a different ending for Tom and Maggie Tulliver, but the ending they got did make the most sense for them.

当然，我本来更希望汤姆和玛吉·塔利弗有一个不同的结局，但他们得到的那个结局对他们来说确实是最合理的。

of course 当然

prefer v. 更喜欢；宁愿

make sense 合理；讲得通

⁷ This was an aha moment for me, and I never thought about endings the same way again.

那一刻我恍然大悟，从此我看待结局的方式再也和从前不一样了。

aha moment 恍然大悟的时刻；顿悟

the same way 以同样的方式

⁸ From then on, if I wanted to read an ending guaranteed to be happy, I'd pick up a romance.

从那以后，如果我想读一个保证圆满的结局，我就会拿起一本爱情小说。

from then on 从那时起

guarantee v. 保证；确保

pick up 拿起

romance n. 爱情小说

⁹ If I wanted an ending I couldn't guess, I'd pick up a mystery (悬疑小说).

如果想要一个猜不到的结局，我就会拿起一本悬疑小说。

guess v. 猜测；猜到

pick up 拿起

mystery n. 悬疑小说；侦探小说

¹⁰ One where I kind of knew what was going to happen,
historical fiction.

如果想要一个我大致知道会发生什么的结局，就选历史小说。

kind of 有点儿；大致

historical adj. 历史的

fiction n. 小说

11 **Choosing** what to read became easier.

选择读什么书变得更容易了。

choose v. 选择

¹² But writing the **end** — that's hard.

但写结局——那可就难了。

end n. 结尾；结局

¹³ It's hard for writers because endings carry so much weight with readers.

这对作家来说很难，因为结局在读者心中分量很重。

carry weight with 在……心中有分量；对……有影响力

¹⁴ You **have to** **balance** **creating** an ending that's **unpredictable**, but doesn't seem to **come from nowhere**, one that **fits** what's right for the characters.

你必须把握好平衡，创作出这样一个结局：它出人意料，却又不显得凭空而来，而且符合人物应有的走向。

have to 必须

balance v. 平衡；权衡

create v. 创作；创造

unpredictable adj. 无法预料的；出人意料的

come from nowhere 凭空出现；毫无来由

fit v. 符合；适合

15 That's why this issue (期) of Writer's Digest aims to help you figure out how to write the best ending for whatever kind of writing you're doing.

正因如此，本期《作家文摘》旨在帮助你弄清楚：无论你在写哪种类型的作品，都该如何写出最好的结局。

that's why 这就是……的原因；正因如此

issue n. (报刊的) 一期

aim to 旨在；力求

figure out 弄清楚；想出

whatever det. 无论什么样的

16 If it's **short stories**, Peter Mountford **breaks down** six **techniques** you can try to see which one helps you **stick the landing**.

如果你写的是短篇小说，彼得·蒙特福德剖析的六种技巧可供你一试，看看哪一种能帮你稳稳“落地”、漂亮收尾。

short story 短篇小说

break down 剖析；分解

technique n. 技巧

stick the landing （体操）稳稳落地；圆满收尾

¹⁷ Elizabeth Sims analyzes the final chapters of five great novels to see what key points they include and how you can adapt them for your work.

伊丽莎白·西姆斯分析了五部伟大小说的最后几章，看看其中包含了哪些要点，以及你可以如何把这些要点加以调整，运用到自己的作品中。

analyze v. 分析

final adj. 最后的

chapter n. 章；章节

novel n. 小说

key point 要点

include v. 包含

adapt v. 调整使适合；改编

¹⁸ This issue won't tell you what your ending should be — that's **up to** you and the story you're telling — but it might **provide** what you need to **get there**.

本期不会告诉你结局应该是什么样的——那取决于你和你正在讲述的故事——但它可能会为你提供写出这个结局所需的帮助。

be up to 由……决定；取决于

provide v. 提供

get there 达到目标；成功